World Bank Manual

Supplement for Chairs and Delegates

This Manual explains the specialised financial procedure used by the World Bank (WB) committee at MoMUN. Delegates manage an assigned budget, negotiate funding for development proposals and decide on each operative clause separately. A proposal must be financially viable and fully funded before it can be adopted.

The Delegate and Student Officer Manuals continue to apply to preparation, speeches, Points, Motions and general resolution formatting, except where this supplement sets out a different procedure. In particular, the World Bank requires exact financial amounts, considers clauses independently and uses weighted voting when a formal decision is required.

The financial allocations and transactions described here form part of the conference simulation. They do not authorise real expenditure or reproduce the full legal and operational procedures of the World Bank. Chairs and delegates should use the committee's published allocation sheet and the same approved financial record throughout proceedings.

The MoMUN Code of Conduct applies separately. Participants should consult it for conduct, academic integrity, electronic devices, attendance and safety. [1]

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The World Bank Committee

Development and Financial Feasibility

The real World Bank consists of the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) and the International Development Association (IDA). IBRD provides financing and advice to middle-income and creditworthy lower-income countries; IDA supports poorer countries through financing that includes concessional credits and grants. [2, 3]

At MoMUN, delegates should connect each proposal to a clear development objective and explain how the proposed funding would produce that outcome. A clause should identify the beneficiaries, the implementing body, the work to be financed and a practical means of assessing progress.

Economic realism includes both the initial cost and the resources needed to operate or maintain a project. Delegates should explain significant assumptions and risks, rather than rely on the size of a budget alone. Chairs should review whether the proposed scale and costs are consistent with the intended activity.

The Conference Model

Each delegation receives a fixed simulated budget at the beginning of the conference. The Secretariat sets allocations with regard to the economic capacity, development role and financial influence represented in the committee. Delegates may fund their own proposals or support clauses introduced by another alliance.

A delegation is not obliged to finance every clause. It may decline a pledge that conflicts with its policy or priorities. Equally, co-submission or a vote in favour does not, by itself, authorise a contribution from that delegation's budget. Funding requires an explicit, recorded pledge.

The model distinguishes three separate questions: whether a proposal is economically credible, whether its costs are fully covered, and whether the committee wishes to adopt it. A positive answer to one does not automatically settle the others.

Before Proceedings Begin

Chairs should publish the budget and voting allocation sheet before accepting financial pledges or calling a weighted vote. It should identify each delegation, its opening budget, its voting weight, the common currency or accounting unit, and whether the budget covers the whole conference or a specified topic. Delegates should check their entries immediately.

Country allocations are issued by the Secretariat. They should not be inferred from a delegation's own estimate of national GDP, World Bank financing eligibility or negotiating influence. Any correction to the allocation sheet must be explained to the committee before it is used.

Managing Delegation Budgets

Budgets and Voting Weights

A budget is the amount a delegation may commit to financing clauses. Voting weight is the value assigned to its vote. These figures serve different purposes. Spending part of a budget does not reduce voting weight, and pledging more money to a clause does not increase it.

In the real IBRD, voting power includes basic votes and share votes. IDA uses its own voting allocation system. The conference should identify whether its published weights follow a particular institution or use a simplified model; real-world voting figures should not be mixed with conference allocations. [4, 5]

The Financial Record

Chairs should maintain a central ledger showing each delegation's opening budget, commitments to adopted clauses, reservations for pending clauses and remaining available balance. Each pledge should identify the clause, amount, financing instrument, confirming delegation and status. Delegates should keep a matching record of their own commitments.

The available balance equals the opening budget less adopted commitments and active reservations. A reservation holds funds for a pending proposal; it does not mean that the clause has passed. Once the clause is adopted, its reservation becomes an adopted commitment, without a second deduction from the balance.

A contribution must not be counted towards more than one proposal at the same time. If two pending clauses rely on the same funds, the delegation must reduce one pledge, provide other available funding or withdraw the reservation from one proposal before the other can be treated as fully funded.

Confirming and Releasing Pledges

A pledge becomes available for the funding calculation only after the contributing delegation confirms its amount through the submission method announced by the Chairs and the Chairs record it. Statements such as "we may contribute later" are not confirmed funding.

A delegation may change or withdraw a pending pledge by notifying the Chairs before the clause is adopted. The Chairs must update the ledger and reassess coverage. Funds reserved for a rejected or withdrawn clause are released. A pledge recorded against an adopted clause remains committed until an authorised amendment changes or removes that commitment.

Chairs may request corrections to an unrealistic or inconsistent budget and may reject a financially unviable proposal. They should explain the problem and obtain confirmation from affected delegations before recording revised contributions. They may not pledge another delegation's funds on its behalf.

The Financial Framework

Required Information

Every operative clause must have a financial framework. It should state the project or action, intended beneficiaries, implementing body, duration, common currency or unit, itemised estimated costs, total cost, financing sources and the amount pledged by each contributing delegation.

Include operating, maintenance, administration, monitoring and reasonable contingency costs where relevant. Explain the basis of material estimates, such as quantities, unit costs or comparable projects. Identify which costs are included in the stated period and how activities continuing beyond that period would be sustained.

If a clause genuinely requires no additional funding, state a total cost of zero and explain why existing resources are sufficient. A zero-cost label should not be used to conceal staff, procurement or implementation costs. Chairs must still review the explanation.

Full Funding and Eligible Sources

All projected expenses must be covered by confirmed, eligible financing before a clause can be adopted. A useful proposal with a funding gap may be returned for revision or further negotiation, but should not proceed to adoption on the assumption that missing funds will appear later.

Contributions may come from several delegations, including those outside the submitting alliance. Only resources recognised within the conference allocation system may be counted. A reference to a company, donor, future tax revenue or another organisation does not create an available contribution unless the Secretariat has authorised that source and its amount.

Do not count a loan twice as both the lender's contribution and a separate new pool of money. Future repayments, projected profits and the same funds passing through different implementing bodies do not increase the amount available to cover the initial project cost.

Financing Instruments

A grant does not normally require repayment. A loan or credit requires a defined borrower and repayment terms. Concessional financing provides more favourable terms than ordinary market borrowing; the relevant features may include interest, maturity and a grace period. Actual IDA terms vary by recipient and financing product. [3]

For a simulated loan, state the lender, borrower, principal, interest or charges, repayment period, any grace period and the proposed repayment source. Explain why repayment is credible. Repayments expected after the simulated decision do not replenish a delegation's current budget unless the Secretariat has expressly authorised that mechanism.

For a public-private partnership, identify the public and private roles, financing responsibilities, payment arrangements and risks. The term describes a contractual approach to delivering public assets or services, not an automatic source of free funding. Any private contribution must meet the same confirmation requirements as other financing. [6]

Debating Clauses

Submitting and Reviewing a Clause

The general requirements for lobbying, submitters, correction and Approval Panel review remain applicable. Delegates should submit the wording and financial framework together, using a clear clause identifier. Each clause should be understandable and financially assessable on its own.

Chairs should check the mandate, proposed activity, costs, confirmed pledges and available balances before introducing a clause for decision. A mathematical balance is necessary but does not excuse an implausible cost estimate or an activity outside the committee's role. Outstanding problems should be explained to the submitters.

A proposal that depends on another clause must identify that dependency and any shared cost. The Chairs should set a debate order that makes the relationship clear. The same shared expense may not be charged or financed twice.

Clause by Clause Debate

Each operative clause is introduced, funded, debated and decided independently. The Chairs should display its current wording and financial framework, identify the submitter and funding contributors, and announce the debate time. Open Debate is used for the clause, while amendments follow the general Closed Debate procedure.

Delegates may assess the development benefit, implementation, costs, financing terms and consequences for their countries. A delegation may support the objective but seek a lower cost, a different instrument or clearer safeguards. It should explain the specific change it wishes to see.

After amendments have been decided, the Chairs should confirm the final cost and contributions before seeking adoption. A clause that was fully funded when first introduced must be checked again if its text or pledges have changed.

Compiling the Final Text

Once a clause is adopted, the Chairs record its final wording and financial commitments. Rejected clauses are excluded from the adopted text. The final resolution compiles the clauses adopted independently, together with the approved header and relevant preambulatory text.

Under this clause-by-clause model, compilation does not require a second substantive vote on the same adopted clauses. Chairs may correct numbering and cross-references without changing substance. A change to an adopted obligation, cost or contribution must follow the amendment procedure rather than be introduced as a formatting correction.

Consensus and Weighted Voting

Seeking Consensus

Once a viable clause has full confirmed funding and debate is complete, the Chairs may ask whether there are any objections to adopting it by consensus. Consensus means that no eligible delegation raises a formal objection to adoption; it is not inferred from a majority of raised placards.

A delegation may decline to finance a clause without objecting to its adoption, provided that other confirmed sources cover its cost. Conversely, being a funding contributor does not remove the delegation's right to object to the final wording. The Chairs should give members a clear opportunity to state an objection.

If there is an objection, the Chairs may permit further discussion within the available time or proceed to a formal weighted vote. An objection prevents consensus; it does not create a permanent veto over a subsequent vote.

The Voting Rule

For a formal vote, each eligible delegation casts its published voting weight as one unit, in favour, against or abstaining on a substantive item. The Chairs add the weights in each category. The number of delegations supporting the clause is not the deciding total.

The proposed default for this simulation is a majority of voting weight cast: the weight in favour must exceed the weight against. Abstentions are excluded from that comparison; an equal weighted total does not pass. The Secretariat should confirm this threshold before proceedings and announce any replacement rule in advance. This default is consistent with the ordinary majority-of-votes-cast principle in the IBRD Articles. [4]

This voting rule also applies to substantive amendments. Where a procedural Motion requires a formal vote, use the published weights and the announced threshold, without abstentions, as required by the general MoMUN procedure. Motions resolved by seconds, objections or the Chairs' discretion continue to follow those methods.

Quorum and the Announcement

Unless the Secretariat issues a World Bank-specific quorum rule, the general MoMUN quorum of one third of registered delegations applies, rounded up. Voting weights determine decision totals; they do not replace the attendance count for this conference quorum. The real Bank's board quorum rules are not automatically imported into the simulation.

Before a vote, Chairs should identify eligible members present, verify quorum, confirm the allocation sheet and display the funded final text. They should announce the voting weights in favour, against and abstaining, the applicable threshold and whether the clause or amendment has been adopted.

Financial approval and political adoption remain separate. Even unanimous support cannot authorise an unfunded clause under this model. If an allocation or count is disputed, resolve it before announcing the final result. A retaken vote uses the same published weights unless the Secretariat has corrected an error in advance.

Amendments and Budget Recalculation

Submitting a Financial Change

An amendment follows the general requirement to address one clause and identify the delegation, target wording, type of change and exact replacement or addition. If it affects cost, contributions, financing terms or implementation, include a revised financial framework showing the change from the current version.

The revised framework should identify the old total, proposed total, contributions to be added or released, and the effect on each affected delegation's available balance. A proposal to increase a delegation's contribution requires that delegation's confirmation. A committee vote cannot substitute for that consent.

Checking the Revised Budget

Before putting a cost-increasing amendment to a decision, Chairs should verify the additional financing and reserve it against available balances. If confirmed funding is insufficient, the amendment must be revised or held for further negotiation. A vote cannot be used to force an unwilling delegation to cover the gap.

If an amendment reduces costs, specify how the reduction affects individual contributions. A release is not automatic until the amendment is adopted and recorded. Where the revised text changes the scope of a project, costs and financing should be reassessed even if its headline total remains the same.

A change to repayment terms, interest, duration or risk allocation may be substantive even without changing the initial amount. Delegates should explain the revised obligations, and Chairs should check that the affected parties have confirmed any changed financing terms.

Recording the Outcome

If an amendment passes, update the clause, financial framework and ledger together. New reservations replace the superseded ones; they are not added on top of both versions. If it fails, retain the existing text and budget and release reservations made solely for the unsuccessful amendment.

An amendment to an adopted clause requires the Chairs to reopen that item explicitly before debate. Until a replacement is adopted, the existing commitments remain in force. Changes affecting several adopted clauses require separate amendments and a clear order so that resources are not assumed to have been released before the relevant decision.

Second-degree amendments follow the limits in the general Manual and require the same financial checks where relevant. Purely grammatical corrections may be handled under the general procedure, but changes to amounts, funding sources or obligations are not automatic corrections.

Worked Examples

A Fully Funded Clause

The following figures are illustrative, not official country allocations or real project estimates. Financial amounts are in millions of conference currency units. Voting weights are separate, unnormalised voting points; they are not percentages and do not need to total 100. Assume no earlier reservations or commitments.

A proposed training and equipment programme costs 12: equipment costs 7, training 2, monitoring 1 and contingency 2. Delegation A confirms 5, B confirms 4 and C confirms 3. The pledges total 12, so the funding requirement is met, subject to the Chairs' review of the proposal's realism and the committee's adoption decision.

Delegation	Opening budget	Pledge	Available balance	Voting weight
A	20	5	15	120
B	10	4	6	90
C	8	3	5	60
Total	**38**	**12**	**26**	**270**

While the clause is pending, the pledges are reservations. If it passes, they become adopted commitments with the same available balances shown above. If it is rejected, all three reservations are released. The voting weights remain unchanged in either case.

An Amendment Increasing Cost

An amendment raises the programme cost from 12 to 14. If C confirms a further contribution of 2, its total pledge becomes 5 and its available balance becomes 3. The revised contributions of 5, 4 and 5 cover the revised cost. The amendment can proceed to decision after the Chairs verify the additional reservation.

If C does not confirm the extra 2 and no other eligible funding is secured, the amendment is not fully funded. It must be revised or held for negotiation; the original clause and its original reservations remain unchanged. If the amendment is funded but rejected in the vote, the additional reservation of 2 is released.

Weighted Voting Examples

Using the weights above, if A votes in favour and B and C vote against, the totals are 120 points in favour and 150 against. The clause fails under the proposed weighted-majority default, even though A has offered the largest individual contribution.

If A and B vote in favour and C votes against, the totals are 210 points in favour and 60 against, so the clause passes if its financing remains complete. If A abstains, B votes in favour and C votes against, the comparison is 90 to 60; the 120 abstaining points are excluded. An equal weighted total in favour and against would fail.

Terminology and Practical Checks

Financial Terms

Principal is the amount borrowed before interest or other charges. Maturity is the date by which repayment is due. A grace period postpones specified repayments; delegates should state whether it concerns principal, interest or both. These features should be explicit when describing a simulated loan.

A grant is financing without the ordinary obligation to repay. A concessional credit is financing on favourable terms, which may involve low interest, a longer repayment period or a grace period. A financing blend combines more than one source or instrument; each component must be identified separately. [3]

Debt restructuring changes the terms for servicing existing debt through an arrangement involving debtor and creditor. It does not, by itself, create cash for a new project. Identify the debt concerned, affected parties and proposed change before claiming a development benefit. [7]

Microfinance refers to financial services designed for low-income or excluded groups; it is not limited to simply distributing small loans. A proposal should explain the service, intended users, provider and implementation costs. [8]

A public-private partnership assigns public and private responsibilities through a contractual arrangement for an asset or service. A pledge identifies a confirmed financing contribution; a reservation holds that amount for a pending decision; an adopted commitment records it against a passed clause. [6]

For Delegates

Before pledging, check your available balance, the project's costs and the financing terms. Confirm only an amount your delegation can cover. Before proposing an amendment, calculate the revised total and obtain confirmation for changed contributions. Before voting, read the current text and distinguish your financing decision from your vote.

For Chairs

Before debate, verify the allocation sheet, currency, quorum rule and voting threshold. Before adoption, check financial realism, complete coverage and the current ledger. After each decision, update the text, reservations and commitments together, and announce released or newly committed funds.

At the end of proceedings, check that the adopted clauses and financial record agree, no delegation exceeds its opening budget, and no amount is counted twice. Refer unresolved allocation, mandate or procedural questions to the Responsible Secretariat Member before applying a ruling.

References

The MoMUN Delegate and Student Officer Manuals provide the general conference procedure. The World Bank financial model in this supplement uses fixed delegation budgets, confirmed pledges and independent clause decisions; the official sources below explain the institutional background and financial terms.

[1] MoMUN Code of Conduct. Open official source

[2] World Bank — International Bank for Reconstruction and Development. Open official source

[3] International Development Association — Financing. Open official source

[4] IBRD Articles of Agreement — Article V, Sections 3 and 4. Open official source

[5] World Bank Group — Boards of Directors Voting Powers. Open official source

[6] World Bank — About Public-Private Partnerships. Open official source

[7] World Bank — Debt Sustainability Framework Glossary. Open official source

[8] CGAP — About Financial Inclusion. Open official source